

AP World History: Modern

Course Syllabus - 2026-2027

“Past events cannot be separated from the living present and retain meaning. The true starting point of history is always some present situation with its problems.” John Dewey

“If you cannot write well, you cannot think well; if you cannot think well, others will do your thinking for you.” Oscar Wilde

Instructor: Eli Tivin, etivin@moeller.org
Meeting: By Email

Want to meet with me?

Send me an email. I am available everyday before school at 6:50 a.m.

Course Description:

In AP World History: Modern, students investigate significant events, individuals, developments, and processes from 1200 to the present. Students develop and use the same skills, practices, and methods employed by historians: analyzing primary and secondary sources; developing historical arguments; making historical connections; and utilizing reasoning about comparison, causation, and continuity and change over time. The course provides six themes that students explore throughout the course to make connections among historical developments in different times and places: humans and the environment, cultural developments and interactions, governance, economic systems, social interactions and organization, and technology and innovation. This is a skill-based class over a content-based class. We use content of the course to help us practice the necessary skills to excel in the course.

Our Question

Our course is centered around normative, value-based questions and through answering these, we will engage with the many disciplines within modern world history. The course is structured around the main question:

How does learning about the past help us understand and make decisions today?

Our Class

Our class is a place of educational inquiry and prejudice reduction. Each of you enters with notions about history, economics, culture, connections, governance, etc. This space is designed to explore them critically and historically, with relevance today. I am about having humor, energy, and engagement in the classroom. Discussion and conversation will be consistent, and high engagement is to be expected between everyone in the class. We are to approach all these topics with curiosity and conversation as we should approach our current lives when learning and making connections. If you have a question, issue, complaint, complication, confusion, or frustration; just ask and talk to me about it and I am sure we will reach a solution.

Readings/Items:

- ❖ AP World History Textbook, *Ways of the World*- provided by Mr. Tivin
 - ❖ Additional readings available within MoeCampus- Website
 - ❖ A 1-1.5 inch binder for classwork/readings/homework
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Course Goals:

As a result of participation in this course students will:

Unit 1: The Global Tapestry (1200-1450 CE)

- Understand the development and interactions of early civilizations and societies.
- Analyze the impact of trade networks on cultural exchange and diffusion.
- Explore the role of religion and belief systems in shaping societies.
- Examine the rise and fall of empires and states during the postclassical era.

Unit 2: Networks of Exchange (1200-1450 CE)

- Investigate the expansion of trade routes and economic systems.
- Evaluate the consequences of cross-cultural interactions and exchanges.
- Understand the spread of ideas, technologies, and commodities across regions.
- Analyze the social, political, and economic structures of trading states and empires.

Unit 3: Land-Based Empires (1450-1750 CE)

- Examine the rise and expansion of land-based empires.
- Evaluate the methods of governance and administration in empires.
- Analyze the impact of conquest and colonization on societies.
- Explore the interactions between empires and non-imperial regions.

Unit 4: Transoceanic Interconnections (1450-1750 CE)

- Investigate the causes and effects of maritime exploration and colonization.
- Analyze the exchange of goods, ideas, and cultures across oceans.
- Understand the impact of European exploration on indigenous peoples and societies.
- Evaluate the development of global trade networks and economic systems.

Unit 5: Revolutions (1750-1900 CE)

- Explore the causes and consequences of political revolutions.
- Analyze the impact of industrialization on society and economy.
- Understand the rise of nationalism and its effects on state-building.
- Evaluate the role of ideology in shaping revolutions and reforms.

Unit 6: Consequences of Industrialization (1750-1900 CE)

- Investigate the social, economic, and environmental impacts of industrialization.
- Analyze the rise of new social classes and labor movements.
- Understand the connections between industrialization and imperialism.
- Evaluate responses to industrialization, including reform movements and revolutions.

Unit 7: Global Conflict (1900-present)

- Examine the causes and consequences of global conflicts, including World Wars.
- Analyze the impact of nationalism, militarism, and imperialism on conflict.
- Understand the role of technology in shaping modern warfare.
- Evaluate the efforts to promote peace and prevent future conflicts.

Unit 8: Cold War and Decolonization (1900-present)

- Investigate the origins and dynamics of the Cold War.
- Analyze the process and impact of decolonization in Africa, Asia, and the Middle East.
- Understand the ideologies and strategies of anti-colonial movements.
- Evaluate the legacies of colonialism and imperialism in the postcolonial world.

Unit 9: Globalization (1900-present)

- Explore the causes and consequences of globalization.
- Analyze the interconnectedness of economies, cultures, and societies.
- Understand the impact of technology and communication on globalization.
- Evaluate the opportunities and challenges of global integration for regions and peoples.

Period 1

Period 2

Period 3

Period 4

Assignments and Grading- Weighed grading system

Participation/Classwork 25%

Participation and discussion are the cornerstone of social studies education. Participation and discussion should be consistent, thoughtful, and engaging with class inquiries and other students on topics in the course. Predominantly these grades will function to see how well you are engaging with others and the material in class. This will be seen in the thoughtfulness of the completion of work in class, and conversations with peers on the subjects we will discuss.

Each day in class we will be working on a skill that is necessary for success in the class and the AP exam, therefore it is of paramount importance this work is held to a high standard. If you have any questions about this, please meet with me.

Homework: 10%

Homework will act as a review for you outside of the classroom. Homework is formative, not so much for me as it is for you to practice your skills and recognize where you need to focus your attentions when we are in class.

Unit Tests: 50%

Tests will be at the end of each unit and will model the AP test. Each question will be stimulus- based meaning there will be a passage or image with the question. Some may contain longer responses, SAQs, LEQs, DBQs, as we progress in the course. The best way to prepare for the exam in May is to have frequent and repeated encounters with what the exam will look and feel like. These will be the best indicators of your performance.

Quizzes: 15%

Quizzes will be given as needed within/between units and make encompass a variety of materials from different units. These are formative to give me an idea of how you are progressing through the unit, making connections, and understanding the material. This can include practice SAQs, LEQs, and DBQs throughout the year.

Policy on Assignments

Late Work/Absent

Homework: Late work will be accepted till the Unit test where the assignment was given, **up to** half credit. Flexibility on this can be on a case-by-case basis due to illness or other mitigating factors.

Classwork: As each class we will be working on something, please contact me to see what you need to complete. If you do not you will receive a 0 for this assignment.

It is the student's responsibility to make up assignments and tests when absent for any reason. When a student knows of an upcoming absence, it is his responsibility to notify his teachers in advance. Per the student handbook, teachers are required to provide make-up work only to those students with excused absences or prior approval from Provost for extended absences

Tech Policy and AI

We will follow all the policies and procedures in the Moeller student handbook. Laptops will be used within class and will be prompted when necessary. There will be no phones used in the classroom, and all will be put up at the front of the classroom. If you have any questions or concerns, please let me know.

Moeller AI Policy: "Responsible Use of AI: Moeller prioritizes student learning and supports faculty in determining if and how AI tools may be used to enhance it in each course. Each assignment will indicate whether AI use is permitted using a Red/Yellow/Green scale; when permitted, the specific scope of AI use will be defined. If not otherwise specified, the default is Red — no AI use. Students are expected to use AI honestly, transparently, and in ways that uphold academic integrity, and violations of the permitted use of AI for any assignment fall under Moeller's Academic Violations Policy."